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Building with Sarvam for India's AI Sovereignty

Why an Indian AI stack is a market, not a sentiment

Community-run session. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Sarvam AI.

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01

The gap nobody is building for

Three numbers that explain why this stack exists

India speaks 22 languages. Its software speaks one.

~800M

Indians who do not transact
comfortably in English

22

Constitutionally scheduled
languages

~10%

of Indians speak English
with any fluency

1

language most Indian
software actually supports

Every product decision made in English is a decision to serve the top decile. That has been the default for thirty years — not from malice, but because the infrastructure to do otherwise did not exist at a price anyone could afford.



The gap is no longer capability. The models exist. The gap is that most Indian developers don't know what they cost or what they make possible.

The ATM that only spoke English

For twenty years, an Indian bank's ATM greeted every customer in English. In a district where 8% of people read English.

The bank's fix was not technology. It was hiring a person to stand next to the machine and translate.

That person cost ₹18,000 a month. Per ATM.

They were not solving a language problem. They were paying, in salaries, the price of software that did not exist yet.



Today that software costs ₹30 an hour of audio. The interpreter cost ₹18,000 a month. That difference is not a technical story — it is a business one, and it is the reason you are in this room.

Sovereignty is a commercial fact, not a slogan



DPDP Act

India's data protection law creates real constraints on where personal data can be processed and stored. Compliance is not optional for regulated buyers.



RBI localisation

Payment system data must be stored in India. Banks and NBFCs cannot casually route customer audio through an offshore API.



Government procurement

Public-sector tenders increasingly require India-domiciled processing. GeM listings and empanelment favour local stacks.



Sector rules

Healthcare, insurance and defence workloads carry residency requirements that rule out most global providers outright.



Latency

An endpoint in Mumbai beats one in Virginia by 200ms+. For a real-time voice agent, that is the difference between natural and broken.



Currency

Priced and billed in rupees, with GST invoices. Sounds boring. It removes a procurement objection that kills deals.



A CISO's constraint list is a developer's opportunity list. Everything a bank cannot legally do with an offshore API is a market someone has to serve.

The budget already exists

Organisations running Sarvam's stack in production today

Aadhaar

Axis Bank

CRED

Decentro

IDFC

IndiaMART

Infosys

LIC

Mahindra Finance

NABARD

SBI Life

Skill India

Tata Capital

Urban Company

CRED Resolve



These are not pilots. This is BFSI, government and enterprise paying for Indic AI at population scale — which means the question is no longer whether there is a market.

Sarvam at population scale, today

2M+

voice conversations
per day

35M

pages digitised

~1 crore

API calls a day
on their own models

<100ms

median latency,
99.9% uptime SLA



Built and operated entirely in India

Sovereign compute, India-domiciled inference, no offshore dependency in the serving path.



Open weights on the flagship models

Sarvam-30B and Sarvam-105B released under Apache 2.0 — you are not locked to the API.



SOC 2 Type II • ISO 27001 • DPDP compliant

The compliance posture you inherit when you build on it — and can put in your own security questionnaire.

02

What we are doing for the next three hours

You will have your editor open the whole time

The session, end to end

Time	Segment	What you do
4:00	Independence Day & the sovereignty thesis	Listen, argue, ask
4:15	The complete Sarvam stack after Epoch	Map the territory
4:35	LAB — the sampler script	Run code against every live API
5:05	Break	Stretch
5:15	Indus — the six-tool agentic platform	Hands-on, real task
5:45	Kivi + Sarvam Code	Watch, then try at home
6:05	The money segment — unit economics	Derive costs live with me
6:30	What you can and cannot build today	The honest map
6:50	What's next, and Q&A	Ask anything



One rule for the whole session: every segment ends with a number in rupees. If we cannot cost it, we have not understood it.

What you will walk out with



Working code

A script that touches every live Sarvam API and prints what each call cost you, in ₹. Yours to keep and extend.



Your own language, spoken

Audio you generated yourself — Hindi, Tamil, Bengali, Marathi, Odia, whichever is yours.



A map of the stack

What exists, what shipped at Epoch, what is announced but not yet callable, and which model to reach for when.



Unit economics

What an AI voice call costs, why 60% of it is not the AI, and when to build versus buy.



The gotchas list

The silent failures that cost people days — wrong parameters that return HTTP 200 and the wrong answer.



A view of the opportunity

Where the platform companies are not competing, and what that leaves open for a small team.



Three hours is a map, not a hike. You will not master this today — you will know exactly where to walk next.

Before we write a line of code

1

Sarvam API key — indus.sarvam.ai

New accounts get ₹1000 free credit. Today's entire session costs about ₹5 of it. If you don't have a key, get one now — it takes three minutes.

2

pip install sarvamai

Python 3.11 or newer. There is a JavaScript/TypeScript SDK too — `npm install sarvamai` — if that's your world.

3

An Indus account — indus.sarvam.ai

We go hands-on with it at 5:15. Create it now so you're not doing signup while I'm talking.

4

Optional — Kivi, the desktop voice tool

For the 5:45 demo. You can also just watch and install it tonight.

!

Type OK in chat when your key works. If something is broken, say so now — not at 4:35 when everyone else is running code.

Who is in the room?



By background

- Working developers — building something now
- Students — CS, IT, AI/ML
- Founders and technical PMs
- Researchers and academics
- Curious, not currently coding



By intent

- I want to build a product on this
- I want to use it at work
- I want to understand the Indian AI market
- I want to teach or write about it
- I want to know if there is a business here



Answer in chat. It changes how I pitch the next three hours — and the best answers become examples I use later today.

“

The model is not the moat.

The workflow, the distribution and the cost structure are.

— The one line to remember from today